

# Thermal Engineering

A complete professional handbook for Course 4021. It covers thermodynamics, gas laws, air-standard cycles, IC engine performance, steam, boilers, turbines, heat transfer, heat exchangers and compressors with diagrams, formulas, solved examples, practice questions, model paper and answer guide.

**Code**

4021

**Credits**

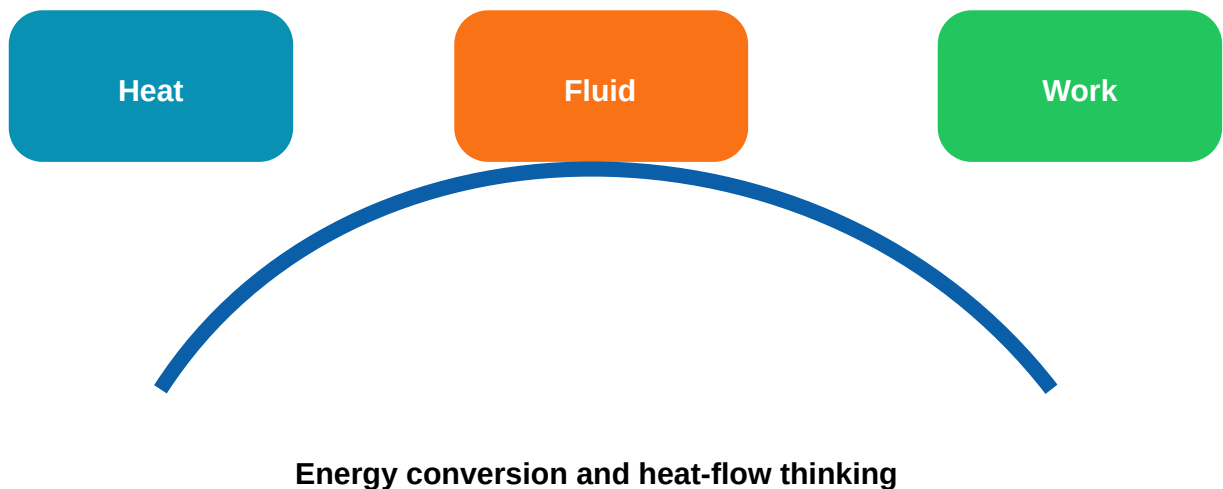
4

**Periods**

60

**Category**

Program Core



## Course Overview

Diagram + formula + unit + explanation = scoring method.

## Learning Roadmap

### CO1 • 16 hrs

#### Thermodynamics, laws and processes

scope and application, system, boundary, surrounding, pressure, temperature, enthalpy, Boyle, Charles, Joule and Avogadro laws, gas equation and Mayer relation

**Draw:** P-V/T-S diagrams, machine line diagrams and flow charts.

**Calculate:** formula-based simple problems.

### CO2 • 15 hrs

## Air-standard cycles and IC engine testing

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air-standard assumptions, Carnot, Otto and Diesel cycles, P-V and T-S diagrams, two-stroke and four-stroke engines, SI and CI engines

**Draw:** P-V/T-S diagrams, machine line diagrams and flow charts.

**Calculate:** formula-based simple problems.

### CO3 • 15 hrs

#### Steam, boilers and turbines

steam formation, wet, dry and superheated steam, steam tables, Mollier chart, throttling process

**Draw:** P-V/T-S diagrams, machine line diagrams and flow charts.

**Calculate:** formula-based simple problems.

### CO4 • 11 hrs

#### Heat transfer, heat exchangers and compressors

conduction, convection and radiation, Fourier law, plane wall conduction, radiation terms, black and grey body

**Draw:** P-V/T-S diagrams, machine line diagrams and flow charts.

**Calculate:** formula-based simple problems.

CO1 • 16 hours

## 1. Thermodynamics, laws and processes

Textbook chapter with definitions, diagrams, formulas, applications and exam writing method.

### Chapter explanation

Study this module as an engineering system: identify energy input, output, working substance, losses and practical limitation. Write answers using definition, labelled diagram, working, formula, application and

Thermodynamics-ൽ system boundary, property, heat, work എന്നിവ വേർതിരിച്ച് പഠിക്കണം.  
Temperature kelvin ആക്കാതെ gas equation ഉപയോഗിക്കരുത്.

## Core topics

scope and application

system, boundary, surrounding

pressure, temperature, enthalpy

Boyle, Charles, Joule and Avogadro laws

gas equation and Mayer relation

heat, work and equilibrium

thermodynamic processes

laws of thermodynamics

entropy and reversibility

P-V and T-S diagrams

## Diagram lab



Thermodynamics, laws and processes

## Common mistakes

- Formula without units.
- Unlabelled diagrams.
- Wrong state or process assumption.
- Skipping application and limitation.

## Expected questions

1. Explain scope and application with diagram / formula / example.
2. Explain system, boundary, surrounding with diagram / formula / example.

3. Explain pressure, temperature, enthalpy with diagram / formula / example.

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4. Explain Boyle, Charles, Joule and Avogadro laws with diagram / formula / example.

5. Explain gas equation and Mayer relation with diagram / formula / example.

6. Explain heat, work and equilibrium with diagram / formula / example.

7. Explain thermodynamic processes with diagram / formula / example.

CO2 • 15 hours

## 2. Air-standard cycles and IC engine testing

Textbook chapter with definitions, diagrams, formulas, applications and exam writing method.

### Chapter explanation

Study this module as an engineering system: identify energy input, output, working substance, losses and practical limitation. Write answers using definition, labelled diagram, working, formula, application and common mistake.

IC engine testing-ൽ BP shaft output ആണ്, IP cylinder power ആണ്, difference friction power ആണ്.

### Core topics

air-standard assumptions

Carnot, Otto and Diesel cycles

P-V and T-S diagrams

two-stroke and four-stroke engines

SI and CI engines

valve timing and port timing

IP, BP and FP

thermal efficiencies

SFC, Morse test and heat balance

### Diagram lab



## Air-standard cycles and IC engine testing

### Common mistakes

- Formula without units.
- Unlabelled diagrams.
- Wrong state or process assumption.
- Skipping application and limitation.

### Expected questions

1. Explain air-standard assumptions with diagram / formula / example.
2. Explain Carnot, Otto and Diesel cycles with diagram / formula / example.
3. Explain P-V and T-S diagrams with diagram / formula / example.
4. Explain two-stroke and four-stroke engines with diagram / formula / example.
5. Explain SI and CI engines with diagram / formula / example.
6. Explain valve timing and port timing with diagram / formula / example.
7. Explain IP, BP and FP with diagram / formula / example.

CO3 • 15 hours

## 3. Steam, boilers and turbines

Textbook chapter with definitions, diagrams, formulas, applications and exam writing method.

## Chapter explanation

Study this module as an engineering system: identify energy input, output, working substance, losses and practical limitation. Write answers using definition, labelled diagram, working, formula, application and common mistake.

Steam table question-ൽ state first identify ചെയ്യുക. Wet steam ആണെങ്കിൽ  $h = h_f + xh_{fg}$  ഉപയോഗിക്കുക.

## Core topics

steam formation

wet, dry and superheated steam

steam tables

Mollier chart

throttling process

boiler classification

Cochran boiler

Babcock and Wilcox boiler

mountings and accessories

impulse and reaction turbines

## Diagram lab



Steam, boilers and turbines

## Common mistakes

- Formula without units.
- Unlabelled diagrams.
- Wrong state or process assumption.
- Skipping application and limitation.

## Expected questions

1. Explain steam formation with diagram / formula / example.
2. Explain wet, dry and superheated steam with diagram / formula / example.
3. Explain steam tables with diagram / formula / example.
4. Explain Mollier chart with diagram / formula / example.
5. Explain throttling process with diagram / formula / example.
6. Explain boiler classification with diagram / formula / example.
7. Explain Cochran boiler with diagram / formula / example.

CO4 • 11 hours

## 4. Heat transfer, heat exchangers and compressors

Textbook chapter with definitions, diagrams, formulas, applications and exam writing method.

### Chapter explanation

Study this module as an engineering system: identify energy input, output, working substance, losses and practical limitation. Write answers using definition, labelled diagram, working, formula, application and common mistake.

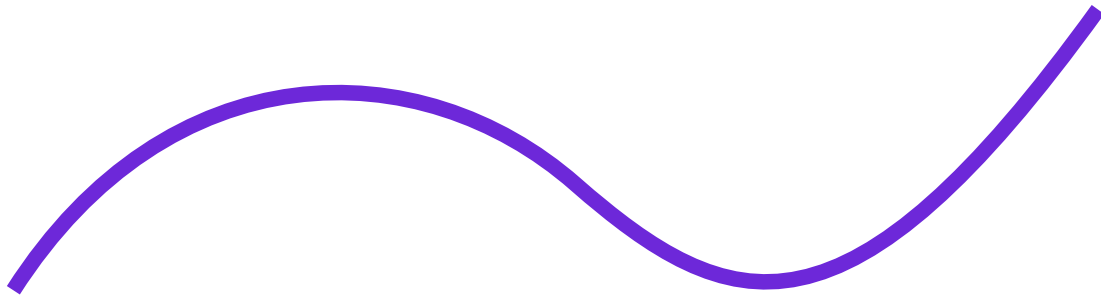
Heat transfer-ൽ mode identify ചെയ്യണം. Conduction solid wall, convection fluid motion, radiation no medium.

### Core topics

conduction, convection and radiation   Fourier law   plane wall conduction   radiation terms  
 black and grey body   Newton-Richman law   heat exchanger classification   effectiveness  
 reciprocating compressor   rotary compressor types

### Diagram lab





## Heat transfer, heat exchangers and compressors

### Common mistakes

- Formula without units.
- Unlabelled diagrams.
- Wrong state or process assumption.
- Skipping application and limitation.

### Expected questions

1. Explain conduction, convection and radiation with diagram / formula / example.
2. Explain Fourier law with diagram / formula / example.
3. Explain plane wall conduction with diagram / formula / example.
4. Explain radiation terms with diagram / formula / example.
5. Explain black and grey body with diagram / formula / example.
6. Explain Newton-Richman law with diagram / formula / example.
7. Explain heat exchanger classification with diagram / formula / example.

## Formula Bank

$$pV=mRT$$

$pV=mRT$  - ideal gas equation

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

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$$C_p - C_v = R$$

$C_p - C_v = R$  - Mayer relation

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

$$W = p(V_2 - V_1)$$

$W = p(V_2 - V_1)$  - constant pressure work

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

$$pV^\gamma = \text{constant}$$

$pV^\gamma = \text{constant}$  - adiabatic process

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

$$\eta_{\text{Otto}} = 1 - 1/r^{\gamma-1}$$

$\eta_{\text{Otto}} = 1 - 1/r^{\gamma-1}$  - Otto cycle efficiency

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

$$\eta_m = BP/IP$$

$\eta_m = BP/IP$  - mechanical efficiency

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

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**SFC=fuel used per BP hour**

SFC=fuel used per BP hour

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

**$h=h_f+xh_{fg}$**

$h=h_f+xh_{fg}$  - wet steam enthalpy

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

**$Q=kA(T_1-T_2)/L$**

$Q=kA(T_1-T_2)/L$  - Fourier law

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

**effectiveness=actual heat transfer/maximum possible**

effectiveness=actual heat transfer/maximum possible

Write variables, units, substitution and final unit in exam.

## Solved Examples

## Gas equation

**Question:**  $p=200 \text{ kPa}$ ,  $V=0.5 \text{ m}^3$ ,  $T=300 \text{ K}$ ,  $R=0.287$ . Find mass.

$$m=pV/RT=200 \times 0.5 / (0.287 \times 300) = 1.16 \text{ kg.}$$

**Exam tip:** Given data → formula → substitution → answer with unit.

## Otto efficiency

**Question:**  $r=8$  and  $\gamma=1.4$ .

$$\eta = 1 - 1/8^{0.4} = 56.5\%.$$

**Exam tip:** Given data → formula → substitution → answer with unit.

## Engine powers

**Question:**  $IP=25 \text{ kW}$ ,  $BP=20 \text{ kW}$ .

$$FP=5 \text{ kW and } \eta_m=80\%.$$

**Exam tip:** Given data → formula → substitution → answer with unit.

## Wet steam

**Question:**  $h_f=640$ ,  $h_{fg}=2100$ ,  $x=0.9$ .

$$h=640+0.9 \times 2100 = 2530 \text{ kJ/kg.}$$

**Exam tip:** Given data → formula → substitution → answer with unit.

## Conduction

**Question:**  $k=0.8$ ,  $A=10$ ,  $L=0.2$ ,  $\Delta T=30$ .

$$Q=0.8 \times 10 \times 30 / 0.2 = 1200 \text{ W.}$$

**Exam tip:** Given data → formula → substitution → answer with unit.

## Practice and Quick Revision

### One-line revision

- Gas law problems need absolute temperature.
- Area under P-V diagram represents work.
- Otto and Diesel cycles are air-standard cycles.
- Steam table use depends on steam condition.
- Heat transfer mode decides formula.

### Industrial notes

- Boiler safety and water level are critical.
- Compressor overheating indicates lubrication/cooling/load issue.
- Heat exchanger fouling lowers performance.
- IC engine performance needs accurate fuel, speed and load measurement.

## Model Paper and Complete Answers

Time: 3 Hours

Max Marks: 100

### Part A

1. Define thermodynamic system.

2. State Zeroth law.

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3. Write  $pV=mRT$ .

4. Define air-standard efficiency.

5. Distinguish SI and CI engines.

6. Define BP and IP.

7. Define dryness fraction.

8. Name boiler mountings.

9. State Fourier law.

10. Define heat exchanger effectiveness.

## Part B / C

11. Explain thermodynamic systems.

12. Derive gas equation and Mayer relation.

13. Explain thermodynamic processes with P-V diagrams.

14. Explain first and second laws.

15. Draw and explain Otto and Diesel cycles.

16. Explain petrol and diesel engine working.

17. Explain valve timing and port timing.

18. Explain Morse test and heat balance sheet.

19. Explain steam formation and steam table use.

20. Explain Cochran or Babcock boiler.

21. Compare impulse and reaction turbine.

22. Solve plane wall conduction problem.

23. Explain radiation terms.

24. Compare heat exchangers.

25. Explain single-stage reciprocating compressor.

## Answer guide

For long answers write definition, labelled diagram, working/derivation, formula, application and common mistake. For numericals write given data, formula, substitution, result and unit.

# References

## Official references

- A Text Book of Thermal Engineering - R. S. Khurmi & J. K. Gupta

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- Thermal Engineering - P. L. Ballany
- Elements of Heat Engines Vol I & II - R. C. Patel & C. J. Karamchandani
- Fundamentals of Thermal-Fluid Sciences - Yunus A. Cengel
- Elements of Mechanical Engineering - Sadhu Singh

## Source limitation

Official information is taken from the supplied syllabus. Missing data is not fabricated.